Brigade HQ who ordered Parab to immediately fall back to Battalion HQ as the Chinese had by then established a roadblock between Dirang Dzong and Bomdila.

A second MLI column, consisting of Delta Company less a platoon and a platoon from Bravo Company, was asked to proceed towards Changdor under the command of Major A. M. Shaikh. This group too was accompanied by an artillery observer, Lieutenant Vinay Shankar, and by the morning of 17 November, moving along the Dirang–Munna Camp–Namshu track, they were in visual contact with Changdor where they could see the Chinese milling around. Vinay Shankar called in artillery fire after which the Marathas decided to fall back despite the fact that Shaikh had originally been tasked with digging in and denying the Chinese an infiltration route.

Reports also started trickling in of Chinese infiltration in the area of Nyukamadung. This added considerably to Anant Pathania's fast-growing despondency. He spoke to the BGS IV Corps and sounded out K. K. Singh about an immediate withdrawal from Dirang Dzong. Singh managed to calm down the GOC and strongly advised him to stay put. Nevertheless, Pathania ordered his GSO-2 (SD), Major Ummat, to put together a layout party and proceed immediately for the Tenga Valley and scout around for a new location to set up the Division HQ. Ummat, however, had no intention of stopping at Tenga and made a dash for the plains, where he was subsequently arrested.

One platoon from Major Kukrety's position at PT 3582 was probing northwards when it made contact with the Chinese. In the ensuing firefight, eleven men from 4 Rajput were killed. The platoon had to be reinforced and only then could it break contact with the Chinese and move back into its prepared defences on PT 3582. This developing threat forced Avasthy to get Bravo Company, which had been protecting Bridge 1, to move up and reinforce PT 3582 with one platoon while the rest of the company was to occupy Gompachar to its rear. The Chinese were quite content to let 4 Rajput alone for the time being, having got what they wanted; with Bravo Company out of the way, Bridge 1 would be cut off if the troops at Se-la panicked and made a run for Dirang Dzong. By 17 November, the trap had been set and now all that stood between the Chinese and success was Hoshiar Singh's Se-la brigade.

4 GARHWAL AT NURANANG